

A collection of insights and resources to help inform Seller Agent work

UXR takeaway from LSS Sales Behavior on Flagship and Understanding the Use of Social Media in Sales Work

- Sellers didn't feel like they could fully understand their customers using Sales Navigator on its own.
 - Using the feed and targeted searches to look at the posts, comments, and reactions of prospects, customers, and competitors.
 - Sellers seek to understand what's happening in a lead or customer's world, in order to identify more conversation-starters and inform their strategy. Critical insights are time-sensitive, flag a problem, or are key to the rep's business. In these cases, sellers want to reach out as soon as possible.
 - Sellers track the activity of customers, prospects, and competitors through their LinkedIn feeds and targeted searches.
 - Sellers also discover new leads by looking at comments and reactions on posts.
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LSS Sales Behavior on Flagship

Customer quote:

"I look at reactions, impressions, and comments. If [a potential lead] was to react to a post, then that would just give me at least an incentive to just go ahead and give them a call and say, 'Hey, I see you like to post about, you know, compliance in the EU markets. Are you guys thinking about expanding? Are you guys looking at pushing your products into other markets?' It's a conversation starter."

-Micah, a hunter-leaning hybrid

Top Current Customer Use Cases on LinkedIn.com

- Researching Inbound or Existing Leads
 - Behavior: Targeted searches by lead or account name (obtained from 3rd party data or their CRM) to look at profiles and company pages of inbound or existing leads.
 - Goal: Understand a lead's or account's background (their education and career path) so that they could identify conversation-warmers and ultimately build rapport with prospects.
 - Tracking Prospects, Customers, & Competitors
 - Behavior: Using the feed and targeted searches to look at the posts, comments, and reactions of prospects, customers, and competitors.
 - Goal: Understand what's happening in a lead or customer's world, in order to:
 - Identify more conversation-warmers
 - Inform the internal sales or customer strategy
 - If you have a critical insight, immediately reach out.
 - Critical insights are time- sensitive, flag a problem, or are key to the rep's business.
 - Across all segments, participants needed to know any job changes (company changes, promotions, etc.), as well as any custom fields that were critical to their specific industry or business.
 - Participants reported discovering new leads serendipitously by looking at who commented on or reacted to a post that they or another customer or lead made.
 - Participants tracked the activity of customers, prospects, and competitors through their LinkedIn feeds and targeted searches.
 - Once they identified a lead in Sales Navigator, they would go to LinkedIn to follow them.
 - If they didn't do so, they needed to manually search for that individual each time they wanted to check up on them.
 - Customer, lead, and competitor posts and comments on LinkedIn informed internal sales strategy and conversational ice-breakers.
 - SOMETHING TO CONSIDER: Allowing customers to make a note from the feed and save it to Sales Navigator; more importantly, sync it to their CRM.
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Understanding the Use of Social Media in Sales Work

- Participants didn't feel like they could fully understand their customers using Sales Navigator on its own - they frequently used LinkedIn (and other social media) to research Inbound & Outbound leads, and deeply embedded themselves in the lives of their customers to build a comprehensive, up-to-date picture of their prospects before reaching out.

- Social media content factors most heavily into the beginning of participants' sales process, where they use customers' posts, comments, or reactions to product-relevant content for initiating contact and fostering credibility with prospects through personalized outreach.
 - Participants ranked posts from prospective/current customers as the most actionable search content signal, as posts provide them with a deep insight into the needs and thought processes of their customers, thus reducing the need for guesswork in personalized outreach.
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Sales Nav saved search Flagship notification tie-in PRD

"A recurring pain point for Sales Nav users is that they are unclear on the value that Sales Navigator adds on top of the consumer LinkedIn experience. Sellers often default to using LinkedIn for their selling activities out of habit, even when they would benefit more from using the purpose-built advanced functionality on Sales Navigator."

How we got to this point:

- A LSS Strategy review with LinkedIn leadership built excitement about what the potential future for Sales Navigator could look like.
- That review led to Tomer (Chief Product Officer) and Team wanting to understand how it could come to life and how it could unlock value delivery to existing Sales Navigator users to create retention and growth opportunities (existing and net-new Sales Nav customers). A prototype was then developed and shared with Tomer. We then got support to explore further.
- With support from Tomer & Team, along with Gyanda (VP of Product) in follow-up conversations, LSS is aligned in wanting to figure out how to actually start bringing this concept to life.

What we're doing

- Meeting sellers where they are to help them stay informed and building a professional brand.
- Flagship is a must-have for all sellers, including existing Sales Navigator users, to build a flywheel around their knowledge and reputation, which establishes the credibility and trust they need to be successful.

- At this time, we're exploring one possible idea but this is not the MVP we're recommending we go with. More explorations for other JTBD will be explored as part of this work.
 - Timeline
 - Explore and design - Q3FY24
 - Build - TBD (pending leadership feedback)
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LSS Sales Behavior on Flagship

"Participants posted or commented on LinkedIn.com in order to increase their visibility, reputation, and brand."

- By posting and commenting, they hoped to:
 - Be seen by potential leads as credible
 - Build their reputation among current customers
- Create a long-term personal brand
- The goal was to indirectly find new leads, and foster rapport and stay top of mind with current customers.
- Participants reflected that this visibility has become increasingly important since the advent of remote work:

Customer quote:

"[LinkedIn] gets me visibility. You just don't have that same visibility now. It's because of COVID and all the different restrictions that have been placed, especially in my industry-- we just don't see people face to face anymore. So how do you create that same feeling? [LinkedIn gives] the ability to just link and connect and to share ideas when everything has to be done virtually."

-Micah, a hunter-leaning hybrid

Social Media & Sales Work UXR

Sellers are too busy to act as marketers for their products on social media. Most participants reported that they don't actively create organic content on social media (i.e., original posts, long-form articles) because it's time-consuming, but instead review customers' content to personalize their outreach and post their marketing departments' pre-created content.

UXR background:

- Sellers often cite Flagship content as an important source of information for lead discovery and qualification, buyer intent, and finding warm paths in.
 - However, browsing and searching across Flagship content is manual and time-consuming, and we have a large opportunity to help sellers quickly leverage content engagement insights to find the right leads in Sales Navigator.
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Content Search Readout

- Trending topics and leads engaging with a topic are equally important: Sellers report an almost equal importance placed on identifying what topics are trending in their industries as they do with finding leads talking about a specific topic.
- Content is used across all sales roles: LI posted content is used by both hunters and farmers.
- LI Flagship posted content is a key source of information for sellers that we should be leveraging more on LSN
 - 57% of sellers leverage content on LI to empower their sales strategies at least weekly. However, there is a ~20% delta between sellers naming Flagship and LSN as a source of this information. ~25% of respondents named LI as a key source of knowledge in their outreach and relationship building vs only ~5% naming LSN as a source they use.